

Tobias Treppmann

Product and design leader — AI shipped into production, in products where mistakes cost people money

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years and led design teams for more than a decade of that, and I spent the last year building AI that ships rather than demos. At Bibel TV that's a support copilot in production and a fundraising system I built end to end. Before that, design leadership at Ninox and ChurchDesk, and five years at Datameer serving banks and insurers.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production — assistive drafting for viewer letters, emails and social messages, following the handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. Restricted topics are enforced in the output. Crisis messages escalate to a person rather than being drafted, and every send decision stays human. Rolled out fully optional, on team-lead encouragement rather than mandate. Complex letters take minutes not hours, temp staff write in the company voice from day one, and sceptics converted after their hardest case.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill. It generates follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Agentic engineering as design practice — prototypes run on real APIs and engineering ships from that code. Around 70% of AI-generated code lands. Iteration went from days to hours.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens with multi-platform sync. One commit reaches every platform, so consistency is structural rather than coordinated.
- Research at Bibel TV — interviews recorded and transcribed in Teams, then analysed with Claude.
- App redesign — leading the iOS, Android and web redesign for engagement and retention, with engineering on the experimentation framework. Direction validated, moving into development.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Booking module, product and design both — reframed a client request into a platform capability, and took €20k of client funding on that condition. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% acceptance, coordinating 20+ cemeteries at the launch customer.
- The rest of the suite was designed and initiated, not shipped — shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified. Only booking went live before the M&A centralisation.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.
- AI in the research loop — Claude to summarise customer feedback, and support tickets plus HubSpot mined for trends, sentiment, feature requests and pain points.
- 1 direct report (designer). Main customer-facing contact for the launch parish, with direct customer contact throughout.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, after my employment there) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview. Chat and direct manipulation coexist. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Dovetail as the shared insight repository, and Claude to analyse thousands of forum posts for sentiment and the pain points and feature requests underneath. Above a few hundred data points that analysis happens or it does not happen at all; below it, I read the responses, because nuance is the first thing a summariser drops.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — established design as a function co-equal with product and engineering.
- Performance calls in both directions — hired two, let two go. Coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship. Set up shared design-system governance across 4 designers and engineering.
- Redesigned how the team ran meetings — pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking, decisions written down. An engineer who had been talked over became one of the strongest contributors, and the habits outlived the problem. Inclusion as a design problem, not a value statement.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the service organisation. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams. Primary stakeholder contact for the programme.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Design system, co-built — UX defined component behaviour and specs. UI executed the visual system.
- Research inside regulated industries — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach personas working inside banks and insurers.
- Design as a business partner — secured executive support for research and measurably increased UX maturity. Time-boxed strategic initiatives kept strategy and delivery in balance.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

AI in Production

Customer-support copilot live in production · AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Human-in-the-loop by design: escalation as a first-class output, the send decision stays human · AI under GDPR-plus data-protection law · Agentic engineering with Claude Code on real APIs

Design Leadership

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Performance calls in both directions · Coaching design leads through stakeholder conflict · Shared design-system governance across designers and engineering · Design established as co-equal with product and engineering

Regulated and Consequential-Stakes Product

Top US / CA / UK banks and insurers · GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law across six countries · EU accessibility compliance shipped · Research methods that reach users inside regulated institutions

Design Systems and Cross-Platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Live sync to Android and Figma, iOS and web endpoints defined · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma Variables · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

AI in the Research Process

Claude for customer-feedback summarisation and for mining support tickets and HubSpot · Dovetail as a shared insight repository · Teams transcription into Claude analysis for interviews · The rule: AI analysis above a few hundred data points, where the alternative is not doing the work; direct reading below that, for the nuance a summariser drops

Research, Experimentation and Multi-Market

Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas · A/B testing and experimentation infrastructure · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · Cross-Atlantic delivery across a six-hour gap · German native, English C2